

FREE PLAYBOOK

Brand voice extraction prompt

Pull your real voice from what you actually publish, not what your style guide says.

by Allen Anant Thomas, founder of The Growth Engine

READ TIME

~5 minutes. Read it once, apply it today.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The setup

Your style guide describes how you want to sound. Your published work shows how you actually sound. Those two voices are usually different, and the gap is why your content feels off when a freelancer or junior writer drafts it. With a 1 million token context window in Claude Opus 4.7, you can now feed the model your last 6 to 12 months of writing in one shot and get a voice profile built from real evidence. This playbook walks through the exact steps, the prompt, and what to do with the output.

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Gather six to twelve months of writing

Open a fresh Google Doc and paste in everything you have published under your name or your company name since roughly October 2025. Blog posts, LinkedIn posts, newsletters, sales emails, landing page copy, podcast transcripts. Skip anything ghostwritten by an agency or a tool that does not sound like you. Aim for 30,000 to 150,000 words. Tag each section with a header like [BLOG], [LINKEDIN], [EMAIL] so the model can compare formats. Export the doc as a .txt or .md file. That single file becomes your corpus.

- Skip anything ghostwritten or heavily edited by someone else.
- Tag each section by channel so format patterns surface.
- 30,000 to 150,000 words is the sweet spot.

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Load the corpus into Claude Opus 4.7

Go to claude.ai, start a new chat, and confirm the model selector is set to Claude Opus 4.7. Drag your .txt or .md file directly into the chat window. The 1 million token window holds roughly 750,000 words, so a year of content will fit comfortably. Wait for the file to finish processing before sending the prompt. If you are on the free plan, upgrade to Pro for the month. The token limits on free are too tight for a corpus this size, and you will hit a cap mid-analysis.

- Use claude.ai, not the API, for the first run.
- Drag the file in. Do not paste raw text.
- Pro plan minimum. Free will cut off.

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Run the voice extraction prompt

Send the prompt below as your first message after the file uploads. It asks Claude to act as a forensic editor and pull patterns from the writing itself, not invent them. You will get back a structured voice profile covering vocabulary, sentence rhythm, and recurring moves. Do not edit the prompt on the first pass. Run it as written, read the output, then iterate. The structure matters because vague asks like 'describe my brand voice' produce vague answers. Specific asks produce specific evidence you can act on.

COPY-PASTE PROMPT

You are a forensic editor. The attached file contains everything I have published over the last 12 months. Analyse it and return: 1) The 5 words or phrases I overuse, with frequency counts and one example each. 2) Average sentence length per channel (blog vs LinkedIn vs email) and the 3 most common sentence structures I rely on. 3) My 3 signature rhetorical moves (how I open, how I transition, how I close). 4) 5 words that appear nowhere in my writing that I should consider. Use only evidence from the file. Quote me directly.

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Build a do-not-use list

Look at the overused words Claude flagged. Most writers have two or three filler words they reach for without noticing. Common offenders are 'really', 'just', 'actually', 'super', 'very'. Pick the worst three and put them on a do-not-use list. Add this list to the system prompt of any AI tool that drafts in your voice, including ChatGPT custom instructions, Claude Projects, or your Notion AI workspace. Also paste it into the brief you give any contractor. This single change tightens copy more than any other voice exercise you can do in an afternoon.

- Pick three filler words, not ten.
- Add the list to ChatGPT custom instructions and Claude Projects.
- Share with any contractor or freelancer drafting for you.

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Lock the rhythm rules per channel

Claude will give you average sentence length per channel. If your LinkedIn posts average 11 words per sentence and your blog posts average 22, that is not random. That is your real voice adjusting to context. Write those numbers down as rules. For example: LinkedIn sentences stay under 14 words. Blog sentences average 20. Email sentences sit between the two. Now any draft can be checked against the rule with a word counter or a quick Claude pass. This is how you keep voice consistent when you are not the one writing.

COPY-PASTE PROMPT

Here is a draft for [LinkedIn / blog / email]. Compare it against my voice profile from earlier in this chat. Flag any sentence that breaks my average sentence length rule for this channel. Flag any word from my do-not-use list. Flag any opening or closing move that does not match my signature rhetorical patterns. Return a marked-up version with comments, not a rewrite.

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Re-run the analysis every quarter

Voice drifts. New team members join, you read different writers, your business changes, and six months later your corpus looks different. Put a calendar reminder for the first Monday of each quarter. Run the same prompt against the most recent 90 days of content. Compare the new voice profile to the last one. If filler words crept back in, catch them now. If a new signature phrase emerged, add it to the keep list. Treat the voice profile as a living document, not a one-time exercise. Twenty minutes a quarter keeps the whole content engine clean.

- Calendar reminder for the first Monday of each quarter.
- Compare new profile against the previous one.
- Update do-not-use list and signature phrase list.

RESOURCES

Tools and links you'll need

Claude Opus 4.7

Anthropic's flagship model with a 1 million token window. Available at claude.ai on the Pro plan.

Claude Projects

Persistent workspace inside claude.ai. Store your voice profile and corpus once, reuse on every draft.

ChatGPT custom instructions

Settings panel in ChatGPT where you paste your do-not-use list so every chat respects it.

Hemingway Editor

Free web tool at hemingwayapp.com. Quick check for sentence length against your channel rules.

Anthropic prompt library

Free reference prompts at docs.anthropic.com/prompt-library for adapting the voice extraction prompt to other tasks.

ONE LAST THING

The biggest mistake is treating the output as gospel. Claude is reading what you published, including content you wrote on a bad day or under deadline. Read the profile critically. Keep the patterns that match the voice you want to grow into. Drop the ones that came from a rushed Tuesday afternoon. The corpus is evidence, not a verdict.

Allen Anant Thomas

The Growth Engine

That's the playbook.

If this saved you time, the best thing you can do is share it. Tag a marketer who needs it.

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